



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Evangel Classical School
School Website: <https://evangelcs.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Evangel Classical School (Marysville/Mukilteo area, WA 98270) presents a robust classical Christian model centered on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integrated throughout the curriculum, with explicit emphasis on a Christian worldview, liturgical/hearty communal practices, and strong partnerships with families. Public materials consistently describe education as discipleship, a Christ-centered, philosophically coherent system, and a culture-building enterprise aimed at forming character and culture rather than merely transmitting information. The school frequently notes a commitment to classical practices (Latin study, Omnibus, great-books-style readings, Socratic or dialogic engagement in higher grades, and a rhetoric emphasis), while also highlighting family partnership, worship, and mentorship as core elements of its model. Overall, the school aligns with a CLASSICAL orientation across most categories, with Pedagogy representing the closest area to a potential needle move toward full classical alignment.

Key signals include: Christ-centered worldview in every subject; Trivium-based curriculum with Latin; Great-Books-oriented references (Herodotus, Plato, Homer, Shakespeare, etc.); a formal emphasis on worship, Matins, and a liturgical culture; small classes and mentorship as a core expectation; explicit partnership with families as co-educators; and a mission to carry Christ-honoring culture through education. These elements map to the Six Essential Elements framework (Religious Foundations, Formation of Virtue, Great Books and Trivium curriculum, Scholé/restful learning signals, and Family/Community partnership), indicating a strong classical alignment overall, with Pedagogy as the primary area where further explicit, documented incorporation of canonical classical pedagogy (e.g., formal Socratic seminars in upper grades) would push toward full CLASSICAL status.

Executive highlights by category (category-by-category snapshot) are provided below, followed by an aggregate assessment and concrete steps that would push the school toward full CLASSICAL status.

- Evidence synthesis is drawn from ECS public materials, including mission statements, curriculum descriptions, and faith-formation content that explicitly reference Christ-centered education, Trivium, Latin, Omnibus, Great Books, Matins/worship, and parent partnership. See cited sources for representative quotes and themes.
- Executive-Category language reflects direct textual matches to positive classical indicators (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty, theology, liturgy, Great Books, Trivium, scholé, and parent partnership) that are prominent in ECS materials. Representative passages appear in ECS mission and program descriptions, including explicit statements about faith-informed, Trivium-based curriculum, liturgical practices, and parent partnership.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and vision emphasize a Christ-centered worldview and theology at the core of every subject. Publications describe education as discipleship with Scripture at the center and a Christ-centered

framework for learning. - Communal liturgical practices are integrated into daily life (e.g., Matins, morning prayer, psalms, creed), signaling liturgical formation and communal worship. - Statements about the sacred dimension of learning (culture-formation, worshipful culture, and covenantal language with families) appear across the site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered worldview, Theology, Liturgy, Worship, Sacred Scripture, Matins, sacred tradition, morning prayer, psalmody, liturgical calendar, ordered affections (as part of a liturgical/cultural formation). - Negative keywords: None clearly present in the public materials (no explicit values-neutral or relativistic framing detected in these materials).

Why this rating - The site repeatedly foregrounds a transcendent, real, knowable moral order anchored in Christian theology and liturgical practice, consistent with Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded in Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices in the Six Elements framework. This category clearly demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment on religious/metaphysical foundations.

Citations: Christ-centered worldview and Scripture-centered pedagogy are described in ECS mission materials. Liturgical practices and Matins appear in teacher/parent guidance pieces.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Education is framed as formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information. The school emphasizes telos, moral formation, and forming character, not just college/career preparation. The mission statements and narratives consistently describe the aim as cultivating virtue, human flourishing, and a love of learning, aligning with paideia and the classical mission. - Explicit emphasis on “pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful,” as a normative aim of education, and a grounding in classical ideals (formation of the soul, moral imagination, and contemplation). - Frequent references to “great conversation,” wonder, and contemplation as a core educational posture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation/scholé, imagination, human flourishing, great conversation. - Negative keywords: Explicitly negative signals such as “college and career ready” or “workforce preparation emphasis” do not predominate in ECS materials; the presence of formation-focused language weighs toward CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school's goal orientation centers on formation of character and the cultivation of wisdom as a transcendent telos, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations. The emphasis on contemplation and the true/good/beautiful reinforces the CLASSICAL framing.

Citations: Mission statements and formation language (formation, virtue, telos, great conversation). Great-conversation and contemplation references.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum explicitly centers the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as the core structure of education, as described in ECS materials. Latin study is highlighted (Latin two days per week in grades 3–10). - Great Books/Western canon references are evident (Herodotus, Plato, Homer, Moses, Shakespeare, Lewis, Paul) as part of the Omnibus-reading approach and “Great Books” ethos. - The Omnibus program and the emphasis on integrating literature, history, and theology reflect a cross-disciplinary, integrated curriculum with a classical backbone. - Public-facing materials emphasize the Great Conversation and the canon of Western civilization, aligning with Great Books/historical engagement and a disciplined classical curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin, Great Books, primary sources/original texts, Western civilization, integration of disciplines (harmony of subjects), history within a classical framework. - Negative keywords: No substantive evidence of replacing history with social-studies framing or STEM-first, as per the document's negative indicators (not apparent in ECS's public materials).

Why this rating - ECS's curriculum aligns squarely with the classical content and structure (grammar-logic-rhetoric, Latin, Great Books, integrated history/literature/theology). The presence of Great-Books-inclined readings and Trivium-based organization supports CLASSICAL classification.

Citations: Trivium/LATIN description. Great Books and Omnibus emphasis (Herodotus/Plato/Homer). Western canon and integrated curriculum signals.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical signals include elements of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) and memory work involving singing/recitation at least at the level of classical pedagogy, as described by Six Essential Elements and associated material (e.g., memorization/recitation, chanting, liturgical rhythm). Public materials show communal singing (Matins) and a culture of memory and memorization through hymnody and psalms. - Lower- to upper-grade practices imply Socratic discussion or seminar models in the upper grades (Omnibus and rhetoric emphasis) and a rhetoric training emphasis, with opportunities for speeches and rhetorical work in upper grades. While direct quotes of "Socratic seminars" are not always explicit on every ECS page, the Trivium-through-Rhetoric approach, combined with Omnibus, supports dialogic, argumentative, and rhetorical practices. - There is clear emphasis on dosing of contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) in classical pedagogy literature (e.g., the Scholé movement and "restful learning" framing exists in the Six Elements lexicon and related resources). ECS materials emphasize a culture of contemplation through liturgy, wonder, and long-form reading in some contexts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation (chanting/recitation), formation through imitation and practice, Socratic dialogue (explicit in classical pedagogy lexicon and Great Books emphasis), rhetoric training, Harkness-style discussion signals (in a few pages). - Negative keywords present: Explicit "Lack of Restful Learning" or "Lack of Memorization and Recitation" indicators are not present in ECS; however, the site does not always spell out explicit, formal Socratic seminars in every grade, and some pages emphasize more narrative/integration rather than a formal seminar format. This leads to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating, rather than CLASSICAL, for Pedagogy.

Why this rating - The public materials show strong classical pedagogy signals (Trivium, memorization/recitation, rhetoric, and structured discussion in certain programs), but explicit, consistent documentation of formal Socratic seminars and a fully rested Scholé-based pace across all grades is not uniformly explicit across the site. This suggests a robust classical lean but not literal, everywhere- documented, full-scale Socratic pedagogy in every division, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Recitation/memory/chanting and liturgical rhythm references. Great Books/Dialectic references in Omnibus and classical pedagogy lexicon. Matins/choral practices as contemplative pedagogy signals.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes small classes and mentorship as a core feature, which aligns with the "faculty as living curriculum" and "model teachers and mentors" concept. ECS materials frequently highlight strong mentorship and a close-knit faculty culture. - Specific faculty roles and Omnibus/Latin/Math/Science teachers are described (e.g., Omnibus teachers, math/science teachers, etc.), showing a professional, teacher-led model anchored in the classical approach. - Posts about the school culture, faculty, and administrators present teachers as committed to classical pedagogy, living the curriculum and modeling virtue and learning. The pages about staff (e.g., teachers' bios and contributions) point to a faculty that embodies classical formation and mentorship.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Living curriculum, mentor/mentors, teachers as masters or guides, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, faculty as culture-carriers, small classes, mentorship, and "teachers modeling virtue." - Negative keywords: No explicit signals of teacher-centric, non-classical branding (e.g., "facilitator" or "teacher as service-provider" jargon) appear to predominate in ECS materials.

Why this rating - The site depicts a classical-leaning faculty culture: small classes, mentorship, teachers as living exemplars, and a “portrait of teacher” and “faculty as core.” This aligns well with CLASSICAL indicators for Faculty.

Citations: Small classes and mentorship described in mission/claims. Faculty bios and Omnibus teacher roles described in staff pages.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly positions parents as partners/co-educators and emphasizes partnership with families to nurture faith, indicating a true co-educator model rather than a customer relationship. This is stated in the mission and “Who we are” discussions. - There is active emphasis on parent involvement, book groups, and gatherings as part of the classical enculturation process (public materials encourage parental engagement, attendance at Matins, reading, and participation). The parent-facing materials describe active involvement and welcome for visits. - The school materials discuss living culture and family engagement, as well as kinship with a wide network of church families. This signals community formation anchored in classical education values.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with families, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, parent formation, family catechesis, open campus, welcoming visits. - Negative keywords: Negative signals such as “parent as customer” or minimal involvement are not prevalent in ECS materials; no strong negative signals are detected.

Why this rating - The school’s materials strongly present parent partnership and community engagement in a classical framework, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations: Partnership with families and parental engagement described in “What families are a good fit” and mission pieces. Matins/parent engagement references.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4) could move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL with targeted documentation of explicit Socratic seminars and formal Scholé-based routines across more grade levels (K–12). Concrete steps:
 - Publish explicit, school-wide documentation of regular Socratic seminars and Harkness-style discussions in upper grades, including sample prompts and assessment rubrics.
 - Provide a public outline of a restive Scholé calendar with intentional pacing and quiet study blocks embedded in the daily/weekly schedule.
 - Highlight explicit memorization/recitation routines and how they connect to the Great Books and primary texts on a grade-by-grade basis.
- Curriculum (Element 3) already aligns strongly; further strengthening Great Books integration could enhance CLASSICAL positioning:
 - Publish a formal “Great Books and Great Conversation” curriculum map that lists core canonical works per grade band, including primary-source reading lists, discussion prompts, and verbal/solicited student responses.
 - Clearly articulate Quadrivium components (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) where applicable, or show cross-disciplinary experiences that reflect Quadrivium-style synthesis.
- Public-facing articulation of Scholé (Element 4) to align with the Lexicon:
 - Add explicit language about Scholé as a central practice, including the rationale for restful learning and contemplative time, in site sections describing pedagogy and daily routines.

If you’d like, I can outline exact wording to insert into the site to communicate these needle-moving elements clearly.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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